



**MINUTES OF
FRIENDS OF TELFORD TOWN PARK
ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING**

WEDNESDAY 11 APRIL 2012

Present: Nicola Allen (Park Manager), Tracy Chiang, Alec Connah, Caroline Embleton (Parks), Councillor Arnold England (Telford & Wrekin Council), Linda Fone (Sec), David Grimsdale, Emily Hayman (Parks), Jo Henderson, Brian Herring, Chris Pettman (Chairman), Brenda Pettman, Harvey Sherwood, Daphne Shieber, Norman Shieber (Treasurer), Eileen Smith, Graham Statham, Colin Thompson (Training Manager).

Welcome

CP welcomed those present.

Matters Arising from AGM 2011

These were agreed.

Matters Arising from last meeting, 8/2/2012

Constitution: The updated FOTTP constitution was signed by CP as Chairman and LF as Secretary.

AOB

RAF Cosford 12/7/12: CP asked if there was any further information about the royal visit to RAF Cosford in July which had been mentioned to Friends by the Lord Lieutenant of Shropshire earlier in the year. It is understood that information is currently embargoed, and CP agreed to write to try to obtain clarification. **Action CP.** This will be discussed further at the next FOTTP Executive meeting which is in May.

Bat Walks on 4th May and 13th August: These will be held with John Morgan of the Shropshire Bat Group as previously and marshals will be needed.

St George's Day celebration on 28th April: The FOTTP gazebo will be there and volunteers will be needed. NA asked for help with litter picking and this was agreed. Volunteers at the meeting included CP, BP, ES, CT, and TC.

Culturefest: Again volunteers will be needed, but the event does not take place until July.

Social Networking: CT has made a good start with setting up social networking accounts for FOTTP as agreed at the Executive meeting. The Facebook and Twitter accounts are live and FOTTP on Twitter gained 50+ followers in the first day. The website will have connections to these accounts in the next couple of days.

Visitor Centre: CP gave a description of the entirely eco-friendly building and mentioned that future general FOTTP meetings will be held there instead of the Civic Offices. NA has agreed to lock up, and when the evenings are dark parking near to the Visitor Centre will be available. No displays can be screwed into the wall in case of an air leak, but it is hoped that a free standing display can be put up temporarily. The FOTTP equipment previously kept in CP's garage will be stored at the TWS depot used by the Rangers.

Explore:

BK has produced a new copy of Explore which is eight pages long. It mentions that the new Visitor Centre is open so will not be distributed until it actually is. NA stated that it will be open by St George's Day.

Treasurer's Report and Audited Accounts

As outgoing Treasurer NS gave his report on the accounts for the year ending 31/3/2012 and confirmed that they have been audited.

General Account:

Income = £1,242.50

This was made up of: grants/donations £715.00, sales of plants £101.50 and sales of park booklets and calendars £426.00.

Expenditure = £686.77

This was made up of printing newsletters/reports £82.80, honoraria £50 (secretary) and £25 (publicity), stationary and postage £21.06, printing calendars and card £302.70, bat walks £50, photo competition prized £35, purchase of high vis jackets £53.82 and sundries £66.39.

Summary

The bank balance at 1/4/2011 was £339.35. Together with the income of £1,242.50 this made £1,581.85. Less expenditure of £686.77, the bank balance at 1/4/2012 stands at £895.08.

There are commitments to pay around £250 for the new park benches, £150 for newsletters and eventually payment for the new Park booklets from this account.

Santa Fun Run Account:

Income = £3,724.50

This was made up of donations £700, sponsorship £2,655, registration fees £335.00 and sales (St Georges Day) £34.50.

Expenditure = £3,575.12

This was made up of postage and stationary £34.10, purchase of Santa suits and medals £368.57, refreshments on Fun Run day £135, donation to Guide Dogs £1,500, donation to RNIB £1,500 and sundries £37.45.

Summary

The income of £3,724.50 less expenditure of £3,575.12 leaves a balance of £149.38 to start off proceedings for the 2012 Fun Run.

Chairman's Report for 2011/12

CP gave his report as outgoing Chairman of FOTTP and printed copies were handed out to those present.

Thanks were given everyone for their work as a team over the last year with a particular mention of Park Manager NA and her team, which now includes CE and EH from Harper Adams College who replaced Sam and Matt. The year has seen significant progress in the work in the Park and on the building of the new Visitor Centre which is now near completion. FOTTP had successfully lobbied for this to be in the Park rather than in Southwater. In 2011 the new leader of Telford & Wrekin Council, Kuldeep Sahota and Councillor Arnold England accepted an invitation to attend a meeting and reassured FOTTP of their continued support, including financially.

FOTTP continue to be very grateful for the financial and moral support from our local parish councils, Great Dawley PC, Hollinswood and Randlay PC, Lawley and Overdale, Stirchley and Brookside PC, Madeley PC and Oakengates TC.

Relevant training has been available for and taken up by volunteers throughout the year as part of the big spend.

St George's Day went very well but unfortunately no-one turned up for the Heritage Walk. The Bat Walks, on the other Hand, were well attended. The CultureFest was an extremely successful and enjoyable event. The Twin Tracks have been kept tidy by FOTTP volunteers and three new benches have been placed, with the help of DG.

CP mentioned 3 particular FOTTP successes of the last year and these were:

1. Our first photo competition which resulted in production of a Telford Town Park calendar, sales of which made a small but useful profit.
2. The 5th Santa Fun Run, which was well supported and resulted in donations to RNIB and Guide Dogs of £1,500 each. Particular thanks were given to Trevor Bate of RMP Guarding.
3. Probably best of all, successfully gaining Fields in Trust status for the Arena, thus securing its future.

Election of Executive Committee:

Secretary – Linda Fone

LF is willing to remain as Secretary. This was agreed (proposed by CP, seconded by DG). CP thanked her on behalf of the meeting for her work in the last year.

Treasurer – Chris Pettman (temporary only – volunteer still needed)

NS is standing down as Treasurer this year because of other commitments. CP offered his sincere thanks to NS for standing in as Treasurer for the last year and doing such a good job. There had been no volunteers for this post yet, which is fairly basic as there are not too many financial transactions. CP offered to undertake these duties temporarily and this was agreed (proposed by CT, seconded by NS). As CP is already one of the three agreed signatories, NS kindly agreed to carry on as signatory for the time being. (LF as Secretary is the other signatory). When a new Treasurer is appointed the details can be changed at the bank.

Website Manager – Zanny Garbett

ZG is willing to carry on running the website from York. This was agreed (proposed by CP, seconded by BP). The meeting expressed their thanks to him for his excellent work on FOTTP's behalf.

Training Manager – Colin Thompson

CT is happy to carry on in this role and mentioned that much of the work is done by CE. This was agreed (proposed by CP and seconded by BP). CP thanked him very much on behalf of the meeting.

Media and PR Manager – Bill Kirby

BK is happy to carry on in this role and this was agreed (proposed by CP, seconded by NS). BK was not present but CP expressed his thanks to him for bringing his experience to this task over the last year.

Chairman – Colin Thompson

Vice Chair – position not filled as yet

CP gave notice some time ago of his intention to stand down as Chairman after several years. The Friends were asked to think about volunteering to be either Chair or Vice Chair, but no-one had come forward. The meeting was happy to hear that CT has offered to take on this role for a year to keep things going. CP offered his heartfelt thanks to CT for this and it was agreed (proposed by CP, seconded by DG).

DG asked if CP would like to be Vice Chair. CP replied that as acting Treasurer he will be on the Executive Committee and will be available to help if needed, but someone new is really needed.

Thanks

Councillor England told the meeting that, since he came into post last May, relationships have gradually developed. He is pleased to see the good relationship that exists between NA's team and the Friends and expressed thanks to everyone.

CT gave a vote of thanks to CP and BP for all the time and effort given to the Friends over the last few years.

The meeting adjourned for refreshments and an illustrated talk by Richard Bifield on the life and times of Thomas Telford.

Date of next meeting: Wednesday, 13th June, The Visitor Centre